



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's cook some rice!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you eat rice?
- What different dishes do you have with rice?
- Are they always hot dishes or are they sometimes cold?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about food and drink.
- I can talk about local and international news.
- I can use words like *since*, *for* and *in* to describe duration.





Let's Explore!

How many **varieties of rice*** are there?

* There are 40,000 "*varieties of rice*" grown worldwide.



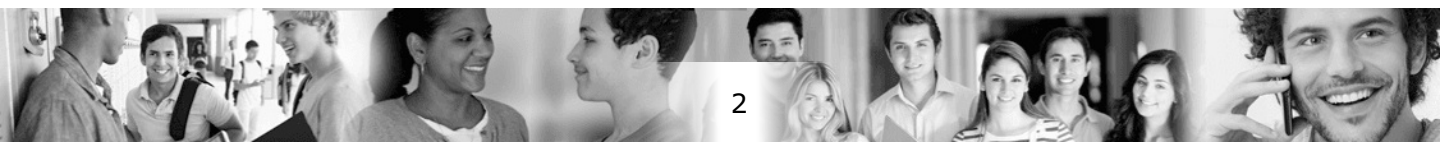
Instructions: Read the text aloud.

People have been growing rice for food in Eastern Asia for thousands of years. It has become the staff of life for half the nations in the world. It has come to be so important to the Chinese that, "Have you eaten your rice today?" has emerged as a greeting similar to, "How are you?"

Farmers have been cultivating rice in the US in Virginia for 400 years. Since then, this practice has spread to other states. In the past hundred years, half of the rice consumed in the US has been grown there.

I read in the newspaper that in North America our tastes have been changing in the past quarter century. Dishes from Asia have been turning up in ethnic restaurants and Fusion cuisine.

A friend, who is a chef, tells me that different types of rice have been appearing in supermarkets in the past decade. More, she emphasizes, keep coming. She has been experimenting for the last few months with a few of the myriad of varieties that have been popping up. Since people have been shifting toward healthier, lighter foods, she tells me, the consumption of rice has risen.





Let's Practice!

Have you eaten rice in the past week?

Instructions: Select the correct answer.

- 1) Farmers have been cultivating rice in the US in Virginia ...
 - a. for the last 400 years.
 - b. in 400 years.
 - c. since 400 years.
- 2) In North America tastes have been changing ...
 - a. in the past quarter century.
 - b. since a quarter century.
 - c. for twenty-five.
- 3) The consumption of rice has risen ...
 - a. for a while shifting toward healthier food.
 - b. since people have been shifting toward healthier food.
 - c. in a long time toward healthier food.



Let's Practice!

Let's learn about rice!

Instructions: Classify the sentences into the correct box.

- Rice has come to be important to the Chinese.
- Our demographic has been transforming.
- Dishes from Asia have been turning up in ethnic restaurants.
- People have been growing rice for food for thousands of years.
- Half of the rice consumed in the US has grown there.
- The consumption of rice has risen.

Present Perfect Continuous

Present Perfect



Extension Activity

Write a report about food you've tried!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Talk with your partner about the types of food you have tried.
- Write a report on how your eating habits have changed.
- Identify a type of food that has become popular in your country and why you have or have not tried it.
- Read your report to a partner and discuss it.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss food I have tried.

☐ ☐

I write about food that has become popular.

☐ ☐

I discuss how my eating habits have changed.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **the staff of life** (expression): a necessary food; a staple food
e.g. In China, rice is the staff of life.
- **to emerge** (verb): to come out, to appear
e.g. "Have you eaten your rice today?" has emerged as a greeting in China.
- **to cultivate** (verb): to grow on a farm
e.g. Farmers have been cultivating rice in the US in Virginia for 400 years.
- **ethnic** (adjective): from a specific place and group of people
e.g. This city has a wide variety of ethnic restaurants.
- **Fusion cuisine** (noun): cooking that combines food traditions from different cultures in contemporary restaurants
e.g. This restaurant is famous for its Fusion cuisine.
- **myriad** (noun): a large number
e.g. There are a myriad of choices when it comes to rice.
- **to appear** (verb): to show up; to become noticeable
e.g. New types of rice are appearing in supermarkets.





Learning Points

Present Perfect Continuous vs. Present Perfect

You use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about an unspecified time in the past that is related to now or continues up to now.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, the time when the action happened is not important.

When you use the Present Perfect Continuous tense, the time when the action happened is also not important.

You can use the **Present Perfect tense** to talk about:

- experience up to the present
- change that has happened over time
- an event or action that happened in the past that is important now

You use the **Present Perfect Continuous:**

- to emphasize that action has continued without stopping until now and may still be taking place
- when you can see the result of an action that happened in the recent past

Example:

Present Perfect: *I have made dinner.* (dinner is ready to eat)

Present Perfect Continuous: *I have been making dinner.* (I am still working on it or I just finished right now)

Present Perfect tense	Present Perfect Continuous tense
Rice has become the staff of life for half the nations in the world. For the past hundred years, half of the rice consumed in the U.S. has grown there. In North America our tastes have changed in the past quarter century.	People have been growing rice for food in Eastern Asia for thousands of years. Farmers have been cultivating rice in the U.S. in Virginia for 400 years. Dishes from Asia have been turning up in ethnic restaurants and Fusion Cuisine.





Learning Points

Since, For, and In for Duration

When you use the **Present Perfect tense** and the **Present Perfect Continuous tense**, you often use phrases or clauses for duration.

These phrases or clauses begin with *for*, *in* or *since*. They answer the question "How long ...?"

You can use *since* to begin a phrase or a clause (as a connector or as a preposition).

You use *for* and *in* to begin a phrase (as a preposition).

Preposition	Example
for (the total amount of time)	<i>for thousands of years</i> <i>for the past few months</i> <i>for 400 years</i>
since (from the point in time that it started)	<i>since then</i> <i>since January</i> <i>since 2010</i>
in (inside that period of time)	<i>in the past decade</i> <i>in the past hundred years</i>
Connector	
since (from the point in time that it started)	<i>Since people have been shifting toward healthier, lighter foods ...</i>

Examples:

- *Since people have been shifting toward healthier, lighter foods, she tells me, the consumption of rice has risen.*
- *Since then this practice has spread to other states. In the past hundred years, half of the rice consumed in the US has grown there.*
- *Farmers have been cultivating rice in the US in Virginia for 400 years.*
- *This means Americans have burned more rice in the past decade than any other people in the whole world!*

